

December 06, 2016

Office of Admissions

I am very glad to write this recommendation letter on behalf of Sami Kaya's application to the freshman program at your university.

Sami has been working with me since June 2016. During the summer, I met with him once a week and exchanged e-mails with him, sometimes daily. Because of this extended and intensive interaction, I have come to know Sami very well.

Sami's study has been focused on computational physics. Under my guidance, he has been learning Matlab and Python (iPython). I give him regular homework, such as simulation of simple pendulum, projectile motion using Python or Matlab. He has a solid background in numerical methods.

Sami is a unique student. **He has been one of most persistent high school students that I have ever seen in my life.** For example, I had worked two other high school students two years ago and they had been accepted to UC Berkeley. Another student was accepted to John Hopkins last year. Sami's level of persistence is about the same. **I also believe that he is one of the brilliant kids in his school at his age.**

I made a list below to come to the point quickly and effectively. I compare him with the high school students at his age. I had worked with almost 50 students as of today.

1. **Intellectual depth - 5 %** : Very few students have the intellectual depth he has. Please spend some time to read his statement of purpose.
2. **Creativity - 5 %** : He asks unique questions. He is very creative.
3. **Motivation - 5 %** : Very motivated. No doubt about that. I have 10 graduate students and he is as motivated as them.
4. **Maturity – 5 %** : He is very mature. He has never missed a meeting. He always brings the assigned tasks on time.
5. **Willingness to work hard – 5 %** : He is willing to work very hard. He is also very responsible. When I give him a task, I know that it will be done timely.
6. **Independence - 5 %** : When I give him a task on subject, he needs minimum guidance. He always figures out a way to attack the problem.
7. **English writing ability - 15 %** : Not a native speaker but his English writing and communication skills are good.
8. **English speaking ability - 15 %** : His English is goodt.
9. **Team work – 5 %** : He has a very nice personality that makes him a perfect fit for a research group.
10. **Overall ranking among the applicant's peers – < 5 %** : He is a great kid with a huge academic potential.

I am pleased to provide Sami Kaya's with my highest recommendation. He will be an asset to your department as he has been for us. Please do not hesitate to contact me by email (burcin.unlu@boun.edu.tr) if you would like to discuss his qualifications further.

Sincerely yours,



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